

sample



The Our Father

The Our Father is the prayer Christ gave to His disciples when they asked Him how they should pray. It is at once simple enough for a child to learn and deep enough to accompany a lifetime of prayer.

In these words, we turn towards God as Father, ask for His Kingdom to come, place our daily needs in His hands, seek forgiveness, and ask for strength to remain faithful.

The prayer is not only something we say. It is also a way of learning how to pray.

Pray these words slowly.

ENGLISH

Our Father, who art in Heaven,
Hallowed be thy Name.
Thy Kingdom Come.
Thy will be done, on earth as it is in Heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
And forgive us our trespasses,
As we forgive those who trespass against us.
And lead us not into temptation
But deliver us from evil.
Amen.

LATIN

Pater noster, qui es in caelis,
Sanctificetur nomen tuum.
Adveniat regnum tuum.
Fiat voluntas tua, sicut in caelo et in terra.
Panem nostrum quotidianum do nobis hodie,
Et dimitte nobis debita nostra,
Sicut et nos dimittimus debitoribus nostris.
Et ne nos inducas in tentationem
Sed libera nos a malo
Amen.

Scripture

Matthew 6:9-13

Pray then like this:

Our Father who art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread; and forgive us our trespasses as we forgive those who trespass against us; And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil.

Luke 11:2-4

And he said to them, "When you pray, say: Father, hallowed be your name. Your kingdom come. Give us each day our daily bread; and forgive us our sins, for we ourselves forgive every one who is indebted to us; and lead us not into temptation."

Reflection

The Father We Share

The first word is not my. It is our.

When we pray the words taught to us by Christ, we do not stand before God alone. We come as His children, and we come alongside one another. The Father we address is not the possession of one person, one family, one nation, or one station in life. He is our Father.

That changes the way we pray.

We ask for our daily bread. We acknowledge that everything we have is received, and that none of us lives entirely for ourselves. The needs of another are not separate from our own. We are invited to remember those who hunger, those who struggle, and those who have less than we do.

We ask for forgiveness, knowing that we ourselves are sinners in need of mercy. The prayer leaves no room for pride. Before we consider the faults of another, we are reminded of our own need for God's grace.

And then comes the difficult part:

As we forgive those who trespass against us.

We ask God to show us mercy while promising to extend that mercy to others.

We cannot pray for forgiveness while deliberately refusing to extend it to another. Forgiveness does not make wrong things right, nor does it deny the hurt that has been caused. It releases our desire to become the judge and places the matter once more into the hands of God.

Even Hallowed be thy Name is not simply a statement about God. It is an invitation to live in such a way that His name is honoured through us.

We bring our needs, our failures, our hopes, and our gratitude before the same Father. Whatever our circumstances or our place in the world, we stand equally in need of His grace.

So, pray the word slowly.

Our.

Let it remind you that you are not alone.

And when you ask for bread, remember another who is hungry.

When you ask for forgiveness, remember your own need for mercy.

When you ask for God's Kingdom, remember that it is not yours alone.

Then forgive.

And let the name of the Father be hallowed in the way you live.